CHEAT SHEET · DAY 5

Programming and production

Macros, loops, modules, the master do-file and the automated release. Every command here was taught today; the deck shows each one at work on the LFS or the CPI.

Macros — Part 1

`local name "text"`	a macro for this run
`` `name' ``	use a local
`global name "text"`	a setting for the session
`$name ${name}`	use a global
`local n = 2+2`	with =: the result
`c(current_date) c(N)`	Stata's own facts
`macro list`	every macro that is set

Loops — Part 2

`forvalues r = 1/7 { ... }`	repeat for 1 to 7
`forvalues y = 2010(5)2025 {`	with a step
`foreach a of numlist 15 25 {`	over numbers
`foreach v of varlist x y {`	over variables
`local name : label (region) `r'`	the label of a code
`capture command`	run, do not stop on failure
`if _rc { display as error ... exit 601 }`	stop with a message

Modules — Part 3

`do "$root/day5/modules/01_clean.do"`	run a module
`* Inputs : ... * Outputs : ...`	the header says what it reads and writes
`use "$root/data/..." , clear`	a module opens its own input
`save "$root/data/x_${quarter}.dta"`	and saves one named file
`local f : dir "folder" files "*.do"`	the files in a folder

Master — Part 4

`version 17 clear all`	first lines
`global root / quarter / ...`	the settings block
`foreach f in "a" "b" { capture confirm file ... }`	check inputs
`capture mkdir "$root/output"`	folders
`capture log close`	then log using, a log named with the quarter
`do "$root/day5/modules/01_clean.do"`	one line per module
`timer on 1 / timer off 1 / timer list`	how long

The release — Part 5

`` `: display %3.1f x' ``	a number as text, one decimal
`putdocx text ("... `: display %3.1f Rate[1]' ...")`	a sentence from the results
`putdocx table t = (8, 4)`	a table
`putdocx table t(r, c) = (x), nformat(%3.1f)`	one cell
`putdocx image "file.png"`	a chart
`putdocx save "f_${quarter}.docx", replace`	write it
`svy, subpop(): proportion x, citype(logit)`	release intervals

Refactoring — Part 6

`Z:\... C:\Users\...`	absolute path: replace by the root global
`* global ... (commented)`	settings switched off: one block at the top
`$name used, never set`	set every global the file uses
`version 17`	first command
`log using "$root/logs/x.log"`	a record of the run
`capture confirm file ... exit 601`	stop with a message

Discipline — Part 7

`data/ raw files`	read only; save without replace refuses
`output/, logs/`	rebuilt by every run
`what_quarter.type`	names that sort and tell
`version 17`	first command, every file
`datasignature set / confirm`	has the data changed?
`one master.do + history`	not five dated copies

The release recipe, in one picture

`master.do`: settings (`global root`, `global quarter`) → input checks → one log → `do` 01_clean → 02_design → 03_estimates → 04_model → 05_report. Next quarter: change the settings, press Ctrl + D.

Help inside Stata: `help` *command*, and the PDF manual linked at the top of each help page.